**Ingredients**
Know what's inside.

# Ingredients – Guide (version 2)

October 2026 · new layout with the bar at the bottom · for Android 7.0 and newer

Ingredients checks food for you: scan the barcode and the app tells you whether the product suits your profile (no pork or alcohol, vegetarian, vegan, allergies, health) – and **why**, with sources. Free, no ads, your data stays on your phone.

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## Part A — Install the app

**Which APK?** On the download page: **"Standard"** fits almost every phone since 2017. If the phone says "App not installed" or "not compatible", take **"Older phones (32-bit)"**. If unsure: **"Universal"** (bigger, works everywhere).

## Before you start

- Be on **Wi-Fi** (the file is about **57 MB**, “Universal” 121 MB).
- Have at least **500 MB** free: **Settings → Battery and device care → Storage**.
- The APK from the download page.

## Method 1 — Directly on the phone (10 minutes)

1. **Turn off Auto Blocker** (Samsung): **Settings → Security and privacy → Auto Blocker → Off** (confirm with your PIN).
2. **Turn off Android “Advanced Protection”**, if your phone has it: type *Advanced Protection* in the Settings search bar. If it is on, turn it off (it forbids any installation outside the Play Store). If the search finds nothing, go to the next step.
3. **Download the APK**: open the link in **Chrome**. If Chrome warns “this type of file can harm your device”, tap **Download anyway**. Wait for the download to finish.
4. **Open the file from “My Files”** (not from the notification): **My Files → Downloads → the .apk file**.
5. **Allow this source**: the phone says “your phone is not allowed to install unknown apps from this source”. Tap **Settings**, turn on **Allow from this source**, then go back.
   Manual path if needed: **Settings → Apps → ⋮ (top right) → Special access → Install unknown apps → My Files** (and also **Chrome**) → **Allowed**.
6. Tap **Install**.
7. **If Google Play Protect blocks it** (“App blocked to protect your device” or “Unsafe app blocked”): tap **More details** → **Install anyway**.
   If there is only **OK**: open **Play Store → your profile picture (top right) → Play Protect → ⚙ (gear)** and turn off **“Scan apps with Play Protect”**, then repeat from step 4.
8. Open **Ingredients**. Done.
9. **Turn the protections back on**: Auto Blocker **on**, Play Protect **on**, and remove the “Install unknown apps” permission from My Files and Chrome. The app stays installed and keeps receiving updates.

## It doesn’t work? Find your message

| What you see | Cause | Solution |
|---|---|---|
| “Installation blocked” / “blocked by Auto Blocker” | Auto Blocker still on | Step 1. Check that it really is **Off**, then restart the phone. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| “…not allowed to install unknown apps from this source” | The app opening the file lacks permission | Step 5, for **My Files** AND **Chrome** (and WhatsApp/Gmail if the file came from there). |
| “Blocked by Play Protect” / “Unsafe app blocked” | Google doesn’t know the app | Step 7 (“Install anyway”, or turn off the Play Protect scan during the installation). |
| “App not installed” / “… package conflicts with an existing package” | An old Ingredients version from another source is installed | Uninstall the old Ingredients (long press on the icon → Uninstall), then install again. Settings must be set again. |
| “App not installed” / “not compatible” with no other detail | Wrong processor type, incomplete file or not enough space | Take **“Older phones (32-bit)”** or **“Universal”** on the download page. Check that the file is complete (57, 48 or 121 MB) in My Files; otherwise delete it and download again on Wi-Fi. Free some space. |
| “Parse error” / “There was a problem parsing the package” | File damaged during the download | Delete it and download again (method 1), or transfer it another way (method 2). |
| Nothing happens when tapping the file | Opened from the notification or a preview | Open it from **My Files** → **Downloads**. |
| “Blocked by your administrator” / work phone | Phone managed by a company (Knox, work profile) | Cannot be bypassed: use a personal phone. |
| Everything done and it still refuses | Unidentified Samsung/Google block | **Method 3** (USB cable + computer): it bypasses the phone’s installer. |

## Method 2 — Get the file another way

Useful if the download fails or the file is damaged. The .apk file can be sent:

- by **Quick Share** from another Samsung phone or a Windows PC (the file arrives in **My Files → Downloads**);
- by **USB cable** from a computer: connect the phone, choose **File transfer** in the USB notification, copy the file into the phone’s *Download* folder.

Then continue method 1 from **step 4**.

### Method 3 — USB cable + computer (always works)

This method worked when the direct installation was refused. You need a computer (Windows, Mac or Linux) and a USB-C cable that transfers data.

**On the phone:**

1. Turn on developer options: **Settings → About phone → Software information** → tap "Build number" **7 times** (enter your PIN). The message "Developer mode has been turned on" appears.
2. **Settings → Developer options** → turn on **USB debugging**.
3. Connect the phone to the computer, **unlock the screen**. At "Allow USB debugging?", tick **Always allow from this computer** → **Allow**.

**On the computer:**

1. Download Google's official "Android SDK Platform-Tools": developer.android.com/tools/releases/platform-tools, and unzip the *platform-tools* folder (e.g. to *C:\platform-tools*).
2. Download the .apk file to the computer (e.g. into *Downloads*).
3. Open a terminal in the *platform-tools* folder (Windows: in Explorer, type `cmd` in the address bar and press Enter) and type:

```
adb devices
```

The phone must appear with the word `device`. If it says `unauthorized`, look at the phone and tap **Allow**. Then:

```
adb install -r "%USERPROFILE%\Downloads\ingredients.apk"
```

(replace with the real file name; on Mac/Linux: `./adb install -r ~/Downloads/ingredients.apk`). When `Success` appears, it is installed.

To finish: **Developer options → USB debugging → off**.

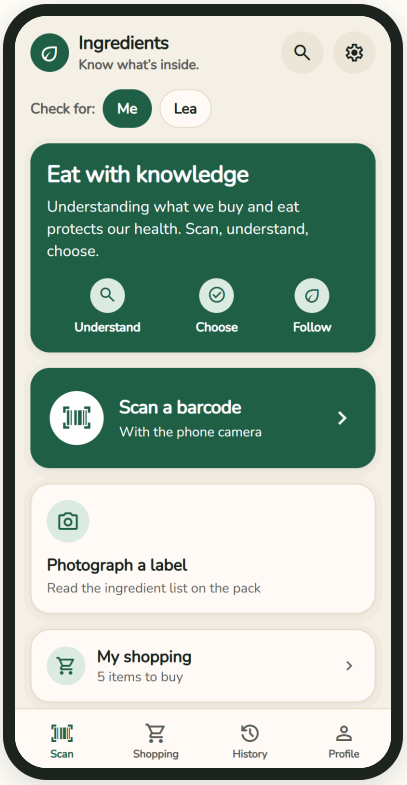
**Safety:** only install APKs from a source you know (here: this page). Always turn Auto Blocker and Play Protect back on after the installation.

### After the installation: updates

- Each time it opens, the app downloads the new version in the background. A banner **“A new version of the app is ready”** offers **Restart to install it**.
- **Scan → gear ⚙ → App version** shows the version and a **Check for an update** button.
- No new APK needed, unless you are explicitly asked.

# Part B — Use the app

## 1 The Scan screen and the bottom bar

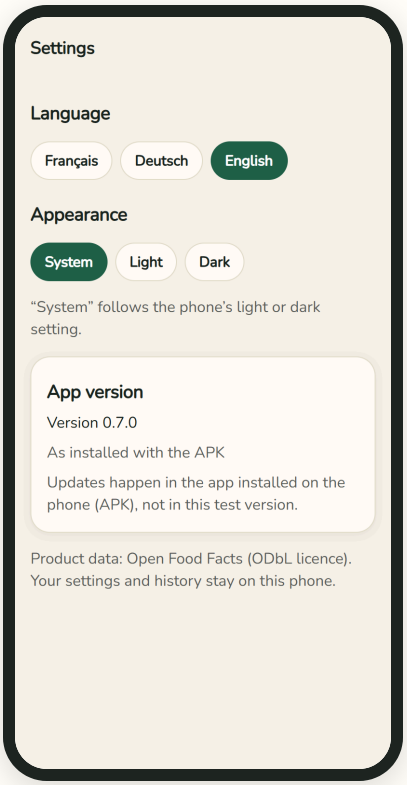



Four buttons always stay at the bottom – one tap to switch:

- **Scan** (the app opens here) · **Shopping** · **History** · **Profile**.
- Top right: the **magnifying glass** 🔍 to search for a product by name or brand, and the **gear** ⚙ for settings.
- **Check for:** shows whose profile is used (when there are several). Tap a name to switch.
- The green card explains what the app is for: *Eat with knowledge* – understanding what we buy and eat protects our health (**Understand · Choose · Follow**).
- Right below: the **Scan a barcode** button, then **Photograph a label**, your **shopping** (number of items to buy), **Recently checked** (your last three products) and the **tip of the day**. At the bottom: **Share the app**.

## 2 Settings (the gear)

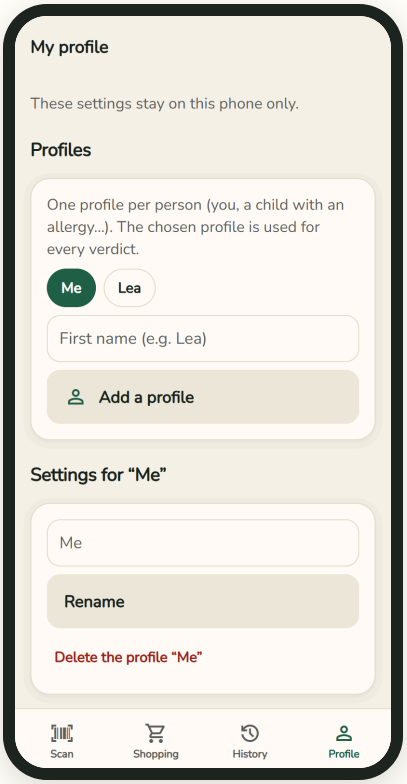
1. Scan → gear ⚙ top right.
2. **Language**: **Français** , **Deutsch** or **English** . On first launch, the app uses the phone's language.
3. **Appearance**: *System* (like the phone), *Light* or *Dark*.
4. **App version**: your version and **Check for an update** .




## 3 Create the profiles (once)

Bottom bar → **Profile** . Everything stays **on your phone only**.

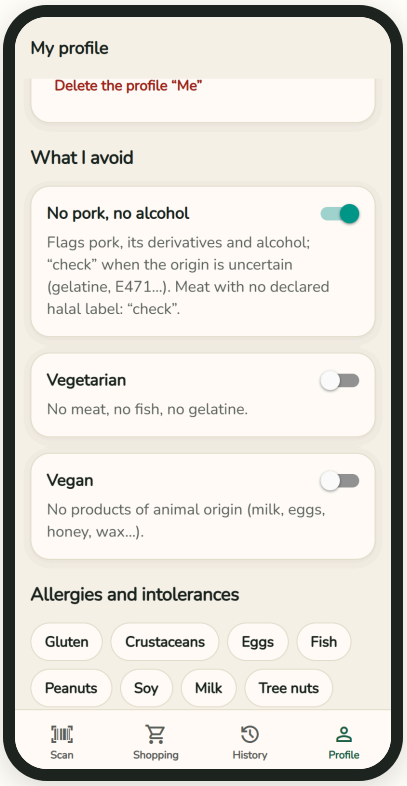
1. Under **Profiles**, "Me" already exists. For another person (e.g. a child with an allergy): type a first name → **Add a profile** .
2. The profile **in green** is the one you are setting up, and the one used for every verdict.
3. **Rename** changes the name; "Delete the profile …" removes it (after a confirmation).



## 4 What I avoid, allergies

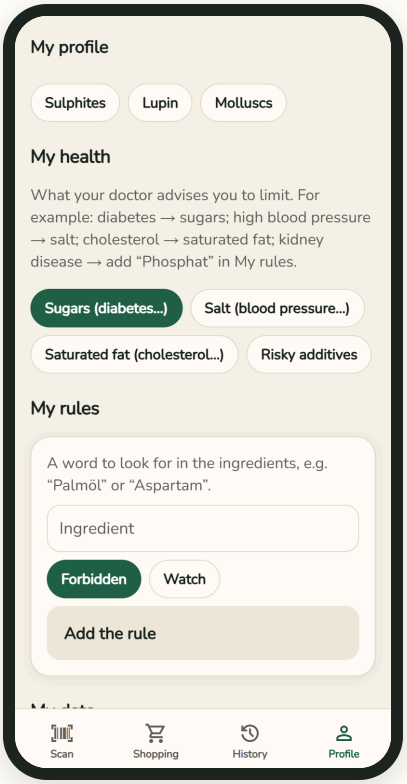
1. **What I avoid**: switches *No pork, no alcohol*, *Vegetarian*, *Vegan*. Under each one, exactly what is checked. With *No pork, no alcohol*, the result also shows, for meat, whether a halal label is declared. Without halal information, the verdict is “Check”.
2. **Allergies and intolerances**: tap the 14 EU allergens that concern you. Selected ones turn green.

Without a profile, the app explains the ingredients but gives no verdict.



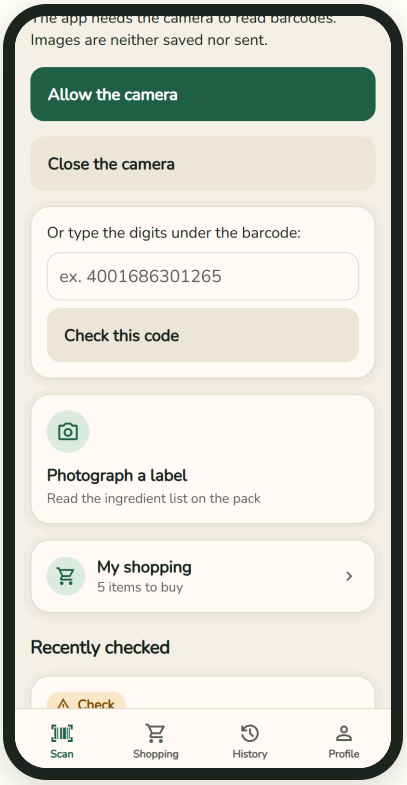

## 5 My health and My rules

1. **My health**: what your doctor advises you to limit – *Sugars*, *Salt*, *Saturated fat*, *Risky additives*. A product high in it then becomes “Check”.
2. **My rules**: your own word to look for, e.g. “Palmöl” (palm oil). *Forbidden* or *Watch* → **Add the rule**. Deleted by mistake? An **Undo** bar appears for a few seconds.



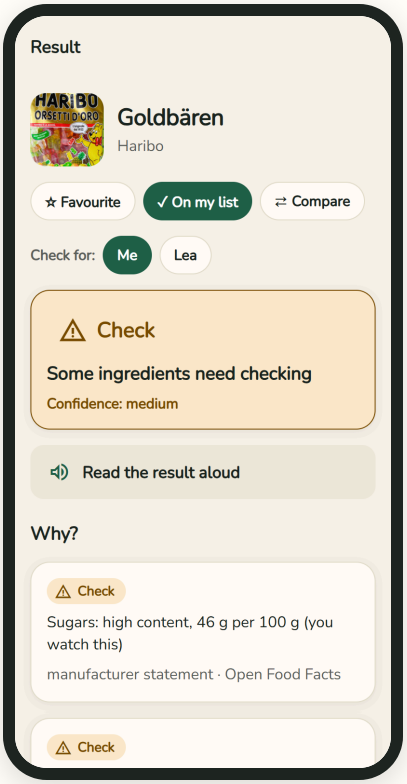
## 6 Scan a product

1. Bottom bar → **Scan** . **Scan a barcode** (under the green card) opens the camera; the ✕ at the top right closes it again.
2. The first time: **Allow the camera** . Images are neither saved nor sent.
3. Hold the barcode inside the frame: it turns **green**, the phone **vibrates**, the result opens.
4. Not reading? Type the digits under the barcode → **Check this code** .
5. On the same page: **Photograph a label** when a product is unknown.



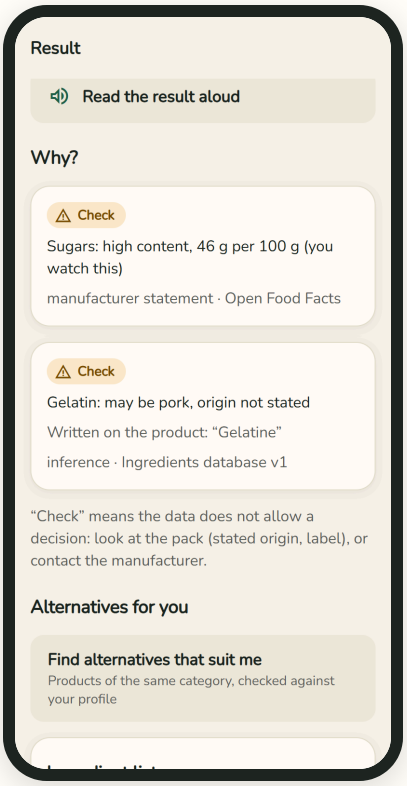

## 7 Read the result

1. At the top: photo, name and brand of the product.
2. Three buttons: **☆ Favourite** , **+ Shopping list** , **⇄ Compare** .
3. **The verdict** in a coloured card: **✓ Suitable** , **! Check** , **✕ Not suitable** or **? Unknown**. Below it, the **confidence**.
4. **Read the result aloud** : the phone reads the verdict. The arrow top left takes you back where you were.



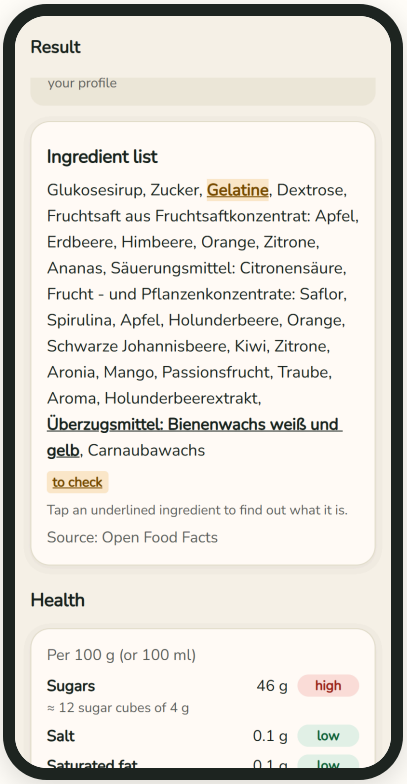
## 8 Why? and alternatives

1. **Why?** lists every reason for the verdict, with the word as written on the pack and its source.
2. “Check” means the data does not allow a sure answer (e.g. gelatine without the animal stated): look at the pack or ask the manufacturer.
3. **Find alternatives that suit me** : products of the same category that suit you. **No advertising**.



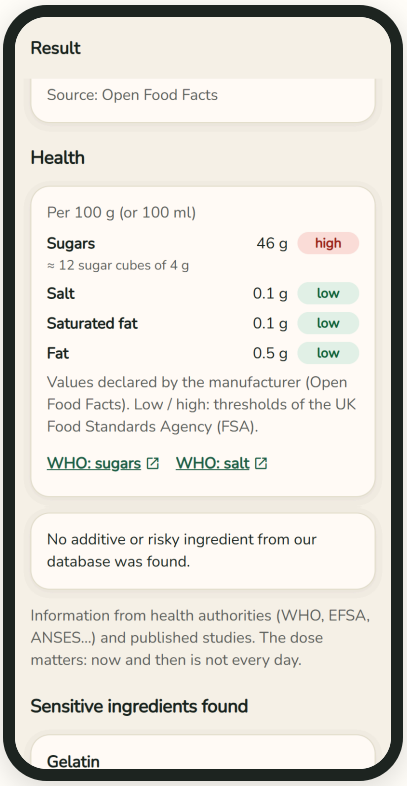

## 9 The highlighted ingredient list

- **red** = you avoid it · **orange** = to check · **purple** = health: watch.
- **Underlined** = explained ingredient: tap it. **Dotted** = not known to the app yet.



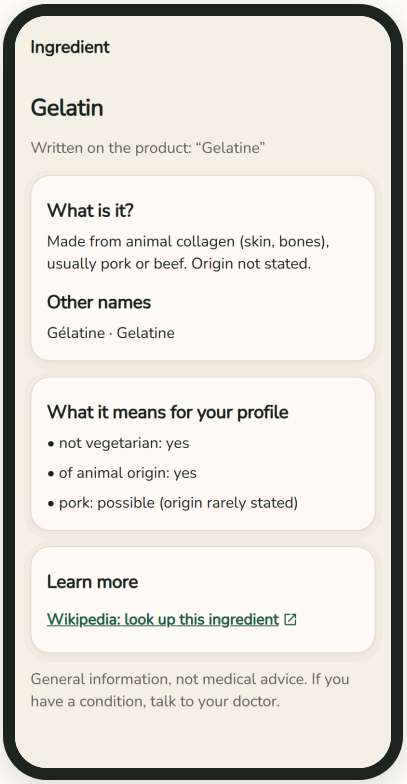
## 10 Health

- Sugars, salt, saturated fat and fat **per 100 g**, with *low / moderate / high*; sugars in sugar cubes, salt as a % of the WHO maximum.
- Risky ingredients and their sources (WHO, EFSA…). A healthy product gets **Good choice!**



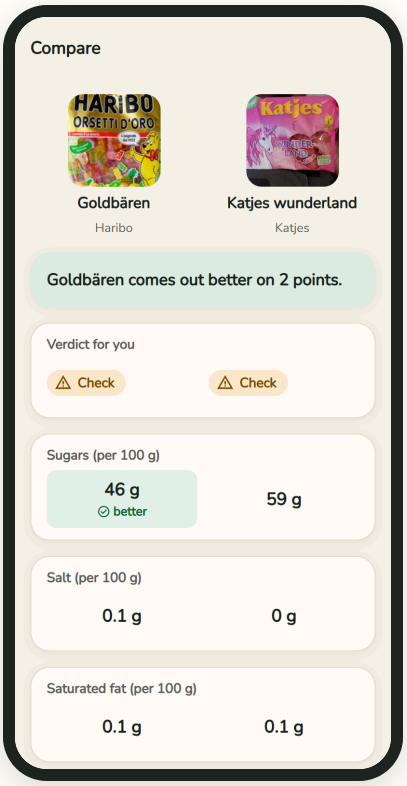

## 11 An ingredient's page

- **What is it?**, **Other names** (E numbers too), **In detail** for tricky cases.
- **What it means for your profile**, effects on health, **official and checked sources** with the date of the check.



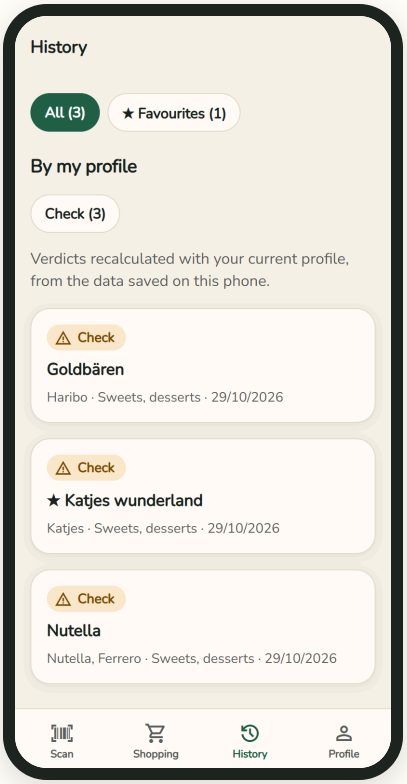
## 12 Compare two products

1. On a product: ⇄ **Compare**, then scan or pick the 2nd product.
2. Both side by side: verdict, sugars, salt, fat, additives, Nutri-Score. The better one is marked **better**.



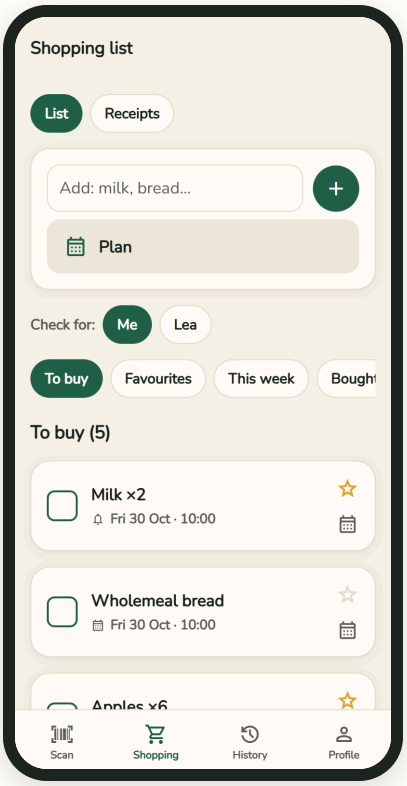

## 13 History and favourites

- Bottom bar → **History**: every product you opened, even offline.
- Filters: *All* / ★ *Favourites*, by verdict and by category. Verdicts are recalculated with the chosen profile.



## 14 Shopping: the list

1. Two ways: on a product, **+ Shopping list**; or, at the top of the list, **type whatever you want** (e.g. “milk”) and confirm with **+**.
2. Bottom bar → **Shopping** → at the top **List**. Tick what you bought; **Send the list** by WhatsApp, SMS or e-mail (with quantities and dates).
3. **Filters**: *To buy*, *Favourites*, *This week*, *Bought*, *Archive*. The **star** makes an item a favourite.
4. **Swipe** an item **right** = archive, **left** = delete. An **Undo** bar appears for a few seconds.
5. Shopping for someone else? Choose their profile at the top: a red banner flags items that don’t suit them.

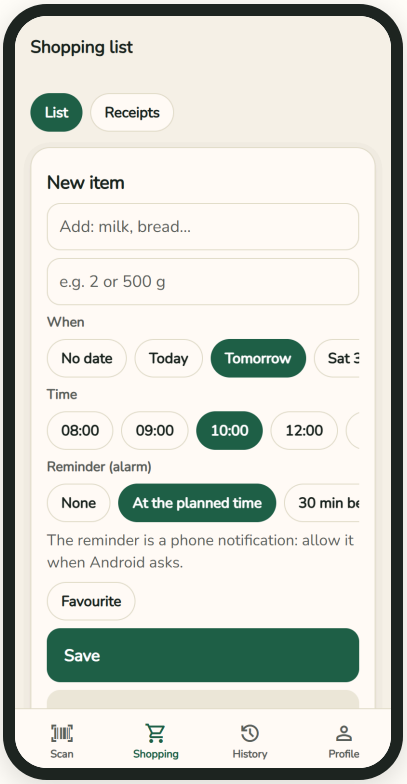



## 15 Plan your shopping, with a reminder (new)

Tap **Plan** (or the calendar icon on an item).

1. **Item** and **Quantity** (e.g. “2” or “500 g”).
2. **When**: a day within the next 14 (*Today*, *Tomorrow*…) and the **time**.
3. **Reminder (alarm)**: at the planned time, 30 min, 1 h or 1 day before. The reminder is a phone notification: allow it when Android asks.
4. **Favourite** → **Save**. The date shows under the item (in red if it is overdue).

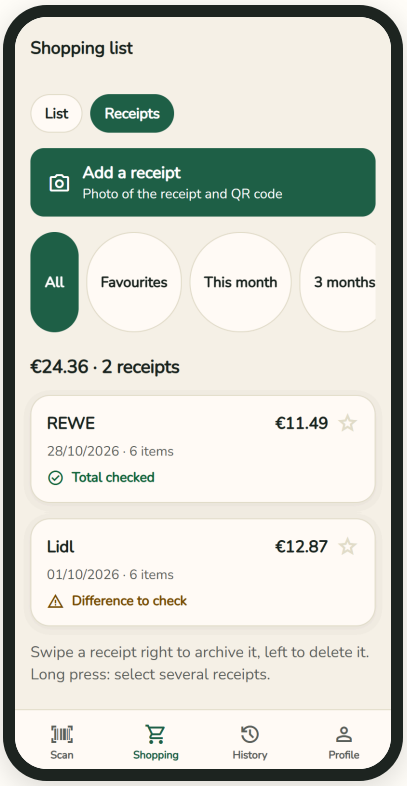
Reminders work from version 0.8.0 (install the new file). A ticked, archived or deleted item no longer has a reminder.



## 16 Shopping: till receipts

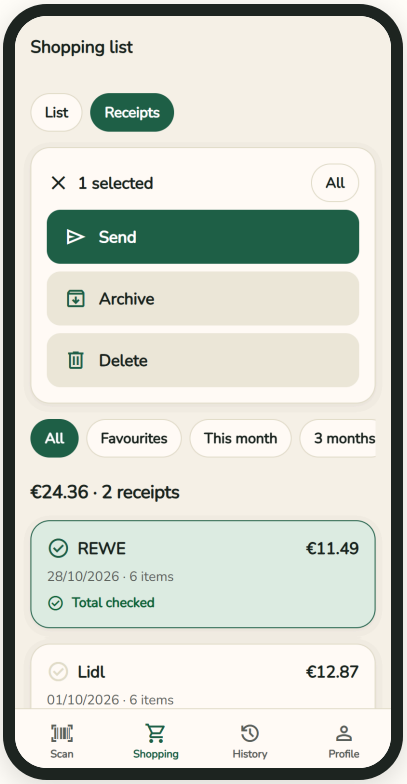
After shopping, keep an eye on what you spend.

1. Bottom bar → **Shopping** → at the top **Receipts**.
2. **Filters**: *All*, *Favourites*, *This month*, *3 months*, *Archive*. Above the list: the **total** and the number of receipts of the filter.
3. Each receipt shows the shop, date, number of items and amount; the **star** makes it a favourite. **Total checked**: the items add up exactly to the receipt total. **Difference to check**: an item is missing or a price was misread.
4. **Swipe right** = archive, **left** = delete (with **Undo**).




## 17 Select and send several receipts (new)

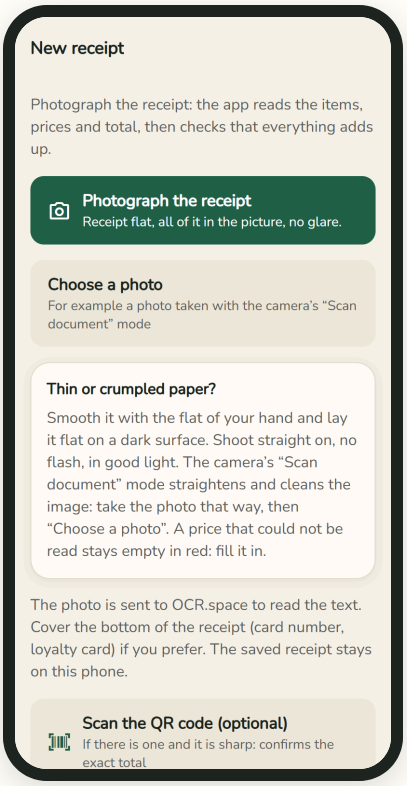
1. **Long press** a receipt: selection starts. Tap other receipts; **All** selects them all.
2. **Send** shares shop, date, total and every item by WhatsApp, SMS or e-mail.
3. **Archive** and **Delete** apply to all chosen receipts (with **Undo**). The ✕ at the top leaves the selection.



## 18 Add a receipt

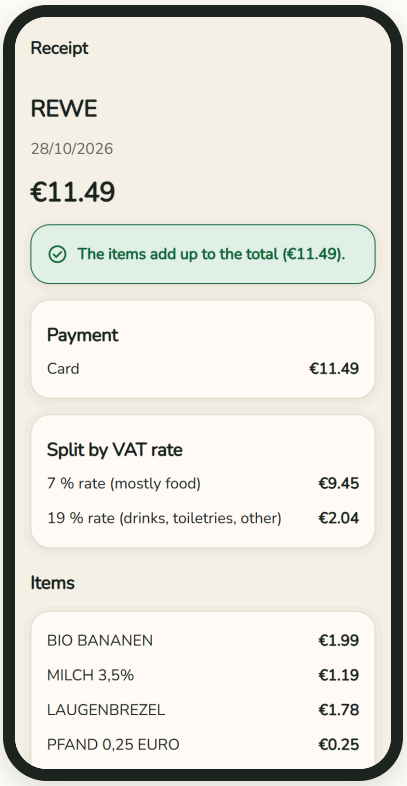
1. **Add a receipt** → **Scan the receipt**. The scanner finds the edges, crops and straightens the image. Long receipt: several shots, top to bottom, without overlap.
2. The receipt is **read on the phone** (even offline): items, prices, total, shop and date. A photo from the gallery goes through **Choose a photo**.
3. Check and correct the items (name, price; a discount with a minus: *-0.30*). An **empty red box** is a price that could not be read: fill it in. **Photograph the rest of the receipt** adds more items.
4. The **Total check** compares the items with the receipt total (or the VAT table) → **Save the receipt**.
5. Optional: **Scan the QR code**, if the receipt has a sharp one. It only confirms the exact total; the items are not in it.

The photo stays on the phone. Only if reading it on the phone fails is it sent to OCR.space.



## 19 View a receipt

- Tap a receipt: total, result of the check, **Payment** (cash / card) and **Split by VAT rate** – 7 % is mostly food, 19 % drinks, toiletries and the rest.
- Below, every item with its price. Discounts and returned bottles show in green with a minus.
- **Delete this receipt** removes it (after a confirmation).




## 20 Search for a product (magnifying glass)

1. Scan → magnifying glass 🔍 top right.
2. Type a name or brand (German often works best) → **Search**. Each result is checked against your profile; *Only the ones that suit me* filters.

## 21 Photograph a label, add a product

- **Photograph a label** (Scan screen): photograph the “Zutaten” paragraph flat and sharp, check the text → **Analyse**.
- Unknown product: **Add this product to Open Food Facts** – with your free account on openfoodfacts.org. It is then recognised **for everyone**.

### 22 Report an error, updates, delete everything

- **Report an error** (at the bottom of every result): a ready-made e-mail, without your profile.
- **Updates** arrive by themselves: “A new version of the app is ready” → **Restart**. To check yourself: **Gear → App version → Check for an update**.
- **Profile → My data → Delete everything**: profiles, history, favourites, shopping list, receipts and account are erased from the phone.

## Part C — Good to know

- The app **replaces neither the pack, nor your doctor, nor a religious authority**. It certifies nothing. With a severe allergy, always read the label.
- When it doesn’t know, it says so (“Unknown”, low confidence).
- No ads, no required account. Product data: Open Food Facts (ODbL licence). To read a photo, the image is sent to the OCR.space service; your profile, never.
- Questions or ideas? Write to draboibro@gmail.com.